

3 At Luna Amusement Park in Sydney, Australia, the Rotor and Big Dipper Rollercoaster are the most exciting rides.

- (a) The popular Rotor ride consists of a large vertical cylinder, which spins about its axis so quickly that any person standing inside is held against the wall when the floor drops away. The passengers maintain horizontal circular motion at constant speed within the cylinder. The normal contact force N acting on each passenger is related to the frictional force f on the passenger by a constant μ as given by the expression $f = \mu N$.

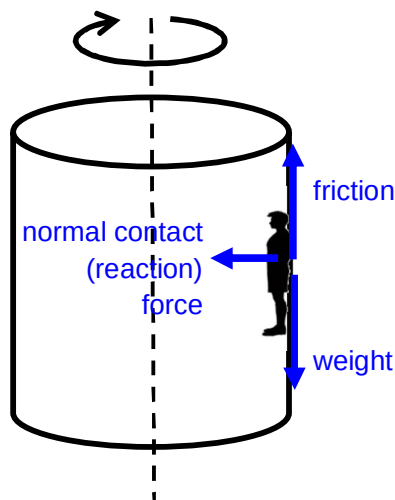


Fig. 3.1

- (i) Draw and label, on Fig. 3.1, the forces acting on the passenger. [1]

All forces spelled out in full and in the correct direction

- (ii) Show that the linear velocity v at which the cylinder of radius R must rotate is independent of the mass of the passenger, m .

By Newton's First Law,

$$\sum F_y = ma = 0$$

$$f - W = 0$$

$$f = mg \dots (1)$$

Normal contact force provides the centripetal force for the passenger to be in circular motion.

$$\sum F_c = ma_c$$

$$N = \frac{mv^2}{R} \text{ where } f = \mu N$$

$$\frac{f}{\mu} = \frac{mv^2}{R} \dots (2)$$

Taking (2) / (1):

$$\frac{f}{\mu} = \frac{mv^2}{R}$$

$$\frac{f}{f} = \frac{R}{mg}$$

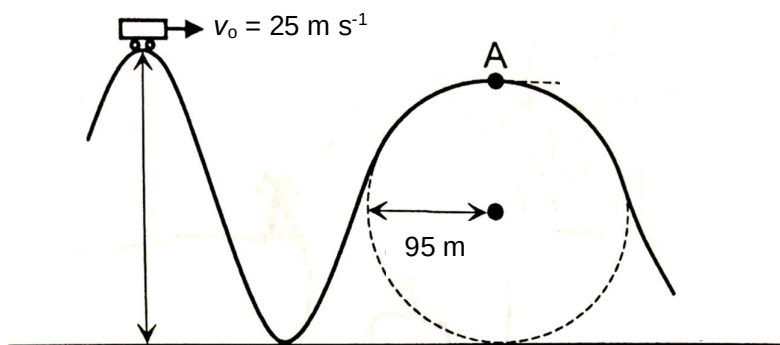
$$\frac{1}{\mu} = \frac{v^2}{Rg}$$

$$v = \sqrt{\frac{Rg}{\mu}}$$

where velocity v is independent of mass m .

[3]

- (b) The cart on the exhilarating Big Dipper Rollercoaster moves with negligible friction along the track as shown. The cart travels with an initial speed v_0 of 25 m s^{-1} at the top of one hill, of height h , before reaching the top of a second hill, which forms a circular arc of radius 95 m .



- (i) Calculate the maximum speed at which the cart can travel without leaving the track at the top of the second hill at point A.

$$\sum F_c = ma_c$$

$$W - N = \frac{mv^2}{r}$$

Upon losing contact, $N = 0$

$$W = \frac{mv^2}{r}$$

$$mg = \frac{mv^2}{r}$$

$$v = \sqrt{rg}$$

$$= \sqrt{95 \times 9.81}$$

$$= 30.528$$

$$= 30.5 \text{ m s}^{-1}$$

maximum speed = m s^{-1} [2]

- (ii) Hence, determine the maximum height, h , of the first hill for the condition in (b)(i) to hold. [2]

By Principle of Conservation of Energy,

$$GPE_{\text{top of hill}} + KE_{\text{top of hill}} = GPE_{\text{At A}} + KE_{\text{At A}}$$

$$mgh + \frac{1}{2}m(25)^2 = mg(95 \times 2) + \frac{1}{2}m(30.528)^2$$

$$h = 206 \text{ m}$$

$$h = \dots\dots\dots \text{ m [2]}$$